

GNU LibreJS for Firefox stops non-free non-trivial JavaScript

A Firefox and Firefox based browser extension called GNU LibreJS automatically blocks non-free, non-trivial JavaScript. GNU LibreJS operates like NoScript on first appearance. One of the primary differences is that NoScript blocks most JavaScript by default, while GNU LibreJS makes a distinction between non-free non-trivial JavaScript and free or trivial JavaScript.

The essay *The JavaScript Trap* by Richard Stallman served as the basis for the creation of GNU LibreJS. Stallman contends that non-free software, primarily written in JavaScript but also in other languages, is run by browsers. Many of these apps are proprietary or not open, and some of them are harmful or problematic. Stallman claims that a JavaScript program used by Google Docs has a size of half a megabyte. It is compressed, which makes it challenging to understand and analyse it.

Stallman advises against running JavaScript that is regarded as being complicated or expensive. Scripts loaded from external pages, those that modify the DOM, and calls to eval are all examples of JavaScript code that fits the description. The GNU website publishes the complete list. When GNU LibreJS is installed in Firefox and other compatible browsers, it makes these distinctions for the user. It enables JavaScript that it deems trivial and prevents all JavaScript that it deems non-trivial.

The extension adds a toolbar icon that indicates how many blocked JavaScript references are present on the page. In addition to controls to change the status of the entire website or specific scripts or pieces of code, a click displays accepted and blocked JavaScript. An entire website, as well as specific scripts or code snippets, can be whitelisted or blacklisted.

The library was built for optimal usability, enhanced APIs, modularity, cross-platform portability, and, when combined with hardware, a project accelerator. Developers can operationalise encrypted data using high-level code, such as C++, which is frequently used on unencrypted data, by combining OpenFHE with Google's Transpiler without having to learn cryptography.

The Google Transpiler simplifies the procedure for utilising FHE-powered applications without necessitating the extensive software development expertise currently required to construct FHE from scratch.

OPPO joins the Open 3D Foundation

OPPO has joined the Open 3D Foundation (O3DF), a non-profit organisation that is a part of the Linux Foundation, as a premier member. By funding open source projects in 3D graphics, rendering, and game development, the O3DF was established in 2021 to encourage collaboration and resource sharing among creators. The Open 3D Engine (O3DE), an open source engine that can power AAA games and 3D worlds of cinematic quality, is the O3DF's flagship project. More than 25 top technological firms support the O3DF, including Adobe, Amazon Web Services, Intel, and Microsoft.



By joining the Foundation, OPPO will collaborate with other industry titans to improve the performance of 3D graphics on mobile devices in addition to helping create and adapt 3D graphics technology for them. OPPO will actively engage in the O3DF Governing Board and its Technical Advisory Committee as part of its commitment to the O3DF. It will also participate in the initiative to form a working group with a focus on the development and adaption of the O3DE for mobile devices.

The O3DE is a cross-platform and modular 3D engine featuring a photorealistic 3D renderer and other capabilities designed to power everything from AAA games to high-fidelity simulations and 3D environments fit for the big screen. The engine is accessible anywhere and is licensed by MIT and Apache 2.0. As a result of the O3DE's entirely modular design, developers are free to select the functionality they require. The engine is very scalable because it is open source and modular, which allows developers to include new tools, features, and development procedures in their projects.

PhotoDemon 9.0 is now available for download

After two years of development, the creators of the free and open source photo editor PhotoDemon have launched PhotoDemon 9.0. The new version has enhanced user interface, built in support for Adobe Photoshop plugins and for new image formats, reduced resource utilisation, and more. Users who already have PhotoDemon installed on their devices can automatically receive the update.